MIL-C-45579B(AR)
4 MARCH 1985
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-45579A(WV)
10 APRIL 1972

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CANNON, 105MM HOWITZER: M137A1

This specification is approved for use by the U.S. Army Armament, Munitions and Chemical Command, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers Cannon, 105MM Howitzer: M137A1 consisting of a tube, and breech mechanism.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. Unless otherwise specified, the following specifications and standards of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Armament, Munitions and Chemical Command, ATTN: SMCAR-LCB-SAS, Watervliet, N.Y. 12189-5000, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 1015

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SPECIFICATIONS

Military

MIL-C-13931 - Cannon, Mortars, Recoilless Rifles and Recoilless Guns: General Specification for
MIL-P-14232 - Parts, Equipment and Tools for Army Materiel, Packaging of
MIL-I-45607 - Inspection Equipment, Acquisition, Maintenance and Disposition of

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-109 - Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-1189 - Standard Symbology for Marking Unit Packs, Outer Containers, and Selected Documents
MIL-STD-1235 - Single and Multi-level Continuous Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

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DRAWINGS

U. S. Army Armament, Munitions and Chemical Command

EPL 11577648 - Engineering Parts for Cannon, 105MM Howitzer: M137A1
Master LQAP 11577648 - Master Index of Quality Assurance Provisions for Cannon, 105MM Howitzer: M137A1
DL 11577648 - Index of Inspection Equipment Lists for Cannon, 105MM Howitzer: M137A1
P11577648 - Packaging Data Sheet, Cannon, 105MM Howitzer: M137A1
QAP-APPENDIX WVA - General Quality Assurance Provisions

PUBLICATION

DA Form 2408-4 - Weapon Record Data

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. The issue of the documents which are indicated as DoD adopted shall be the issue listed in the current DoDISS and the supplement thereto, if applicable.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM D3951 -Standard Practice for Commerical Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19103).

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, drawing requirements shall have first order of precedence, followed by the text of this specification, then the other referenced specifications and standards.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. The contractor shall submit a first article unless it is specifically waived in the contract (see 6.2.1). No first article requirements shall be waived without review by the responsible Engineering Activity and approval by the responsible Product Assurance activity.

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3.2 General requirements. Cannon and parts thereof shall conform to the Engineering Parts EPL 11577648 the requirements of this specification, and MIL-C-13931.

3.2.1 Marking. When specified, marking shall be in accordance with the requirement specified in MIL-C-13931.

3.3 Reliability, availability, maintainability, and durability (RAM-D). The specified performance and design requirements result in a cannon and parts thereof having inherent reliability, availability, maintainability, and durability.

3.4 Functioning. All parts shall function smoothly without interference, erratic movement or malfunction.

3.4.1 Breech mechanism. When the operating-lever is unlatched and rotated rearward (clockwise) it shall rotate the breechblock crank rearward and downward, thereby dropping the breechblock to open the breech. The extractors shall eject the empty cartridge case from the breech chamber and latch the breechblock in the open position. When the extractors are tripped (normally by insertion of a round) rotation of the operating lever counterclockwise raises the breechblock to the closed position. Counterclockwise rotation of the adjustor increases the preload on the breech mechanism counterbalance spring.

3.4.2 Firing mechanism group. During dropping of the breechblock, the cocking lever, forced by a camming surface on the breech ring, engages the retractor. This engagement forces the precussion mechanism rearward thereby compressing the firing spring. During retraction, the sear which is subjected to a torsion load is rotated by the percussion mechanism as well. During overtravel, the sear rotates back to its assembly position, thereby arresting the percussion mechanism in the cocked (ready to fire) position. Rearward movement of the trigger plunger rotates the trigger which in turn rotates the sear, thereby releasing the percussion mechanism. The compressed firing spring drives the percussion mechanism forward and the firing pin strikes the cartridge case primer. Simultaneously, the firing pin retracting spring is driven in the compressed direction. The expanding retracting spring then withdraws the firing pin behind the front face of the breechblock.

3.4.3 Firing pin protrusion. When fired, the protrusion of the firing pin from the front of the breechblock shall be not less than 0.10 inch nor more than 0.16 inch.

3.4.4 Firing mechanism overtravel. Overtravel of the firing mechanism in cocking shall be not less than 0.050 inch.

3.4.5 Headspace. Headspace, the distance from the front face of

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the closed and locked breechblock and the rear face of the tube, shall not be less than 0.188 inch nor more than 0.206 inch.

3.5 Performance.

3.5.1 High pressure resistance. The cannon and repair tubes shall be capable of withstanding 44100 ± 1600 pounds per square inch at 70° F when tested as specified in 4.6.6.1, 4.7.1, and 4.7.2.

3.5.2 Material soundness. After testing all parts shall be free from cracks and fractures, and shall comply with any soundness requirements on the applicable drawings.

3.5.3 Bore enlargement. Bore diameters measured across the rifled lands, after proof firing no more than 8 rounds, shall not exceed the before firing diameters by more than the amounts shown in TABLE I.

TABLE I. Bore enlargement.

Distance forward of commencement of rifling	0.10 inch	1 inch	1 cal.	2 cals. to muzzle
Amount (in inches)	0.003	0.003	0.002	0.002

NOTE: Interpolate to determine the amount between given distances.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 The inspections set forth in the specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of his responsibility for assuring that all supplies and services submitted to the Government for acceptance conform to all requirements of the contract.

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4.2 Quality assurance terms and definitions. Quality assurance terms and definitions used in this specification are in accordance with MIL-STD-109.

4.3 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).

b. First Article-Initial Production Test, FA-IPT (see 4.5).

c. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.6).

4.4 First article inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, (see 6.2.1), First Article cannon and specified parts thereof shall be inspected by the contractor and submitted to the Government for approval. Inspection shall be in accordance with applicable Quality Assurance Provisions (QAPs) and QAP-APPENDIX-WVA. QAPs are listed in Master LQAP 11577648. First Article sample sizes shall be as specified in applicable item QAPs, or the contract, as applicable. First Article cannon and parts thereof shall be representative of the production processes to be used during quantity production.

4.5 First Article - Initial Production Test (FA-IPT). When specified in the contract, (see 6.2.1), First Article cannon shall be subjected to Initial Production Testing by the Government or any agency specified by the Government and may be conducted at a Government facility to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification and any additional requirements listed in the contract. Initial Production Testing procedures and the sample size of first article cannon shall be as specified in the contract. First article cannon and parts thereof shall be representative of the production processes to be used during quantity production.

4.6 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection is listed in Table II.

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TABLE II. Quality conformance inspection.

Categories/Characteristics	Requirement Paragraph	Inspection-Test Method Paragraph
Examinations		
Firing pin protrusion	3.4.3	4.6.4.1
Firing mechanism overtravel	3.4.4	4.6.4.2
Headspace	3.4.5	4.6.4.3
Material soundness	3.5.2	4.6.4.4
Packaging	5.	4.6.4.5
Functional inspection		
Breech mechanism	3.4.1	4.6.5.1
Tests		
Proof acceptance	3.5	4.6.6.1
Test methods		
Proof firing	3.5.1, 3.5.2 3.5.3	4.7.1
Proof pressure simulation	3.5.1, 3.5.2	4.7.2

4.6.1 Inspection provisions. Cannon and parts shall be inspected for conformance with the requirements of this specification, MIL-C-13931, QAPs listed in Master LQAP 11577648, and QAP-APPENDIX-WVA.

4.6.2 Inspection approval stamp. The application of the inspection approval stamp shall be as specified in MIL-C-13931.

4.6.3 Inspection equipment. Data lists containing equipment used in the inspection of parts, subassemblies, and assemblies are listed in DL 11577648.

4.6.3.1 Acquistions, maintenance, and disposition. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), responsibility for acquistion, maintenance, and disposition of acceptance inspection and test equipment referenced in the List of Inspection Equipment DL 11577648, and for all other inspection equipment required to perform inspection prescribed by aplicable specifications, shall be in accordance with MIL-I-45607. (see 6.4).

4.6.3.2 Accuracy of standard measuring equipment. When commerical and modified commercial inspection and test equipment is used, it shall be capable of repetitive measurements to an

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accuracy of 10 percent of the total tolerance of the characteristic being inspected.

4.6.4 Examinations.

4.6.4.1 Firing pin protrusion. The protrusion of the firing pin from the front of each breechblock shall be gaged using Gage 7248891 (2 pieces) or approved equivalent before assembly of the breechblock into the breech recess. After assembly of the firing mechanism into the breechblock, push the firing pin fully forward and gage the protrusion by use of piece 2 of Gage 7248891. Failure to meet the requirements of 3.4.3 shall be cause for rejection.

4.6.4.2 Firing mechanism overtravel. Firing mechanism overtravel shall be determined on each breech mechanism using a depth gage as follows: With the breech mechanism assembled in the tube, remove the firing mechanism retainer from the block. Lower the breechblock slowly to the point where the cocking mechanism engages the firing mechanism, as indicated by an audible click. Holding the breechblock in this position, measure with a depth gage and record the distance from the rear face of the firing pin guide. Holding the depth gage in position against the breechblock, slowly lower the breechblock to the bottom of the travel. Movement of the breechblock will cause the firing pin guide to move backward. This firing pin guide movement will cause the depth gage reading to change. At some point, the depth gage reading will be a miminum. This point may or may not be at the bottom of the breechblock travel, due to the curved cam surface of the block plus tolerance build-up on components involved. Record the miminum depth gage reading. Subtract the second reading from the first reading to determine the overtravel of the firing mechanism. Failure to meet the requirements of 3.4.4 shall be cause for rejection.

4.6.4.3 Headspace. Headspace shall be measured on each cannon with gages 8773818 and 8773819 or approved equivalents. Failure to meet the requirements of 3.4.5 shall be cause for rejection.

4.6.4.4 Material soundness. All external surfaces of the tube and all surfaces of the breech ring and the breechblock shall be examined by magnetic-particle inspection in accordance with applicable specifications. Acceptance criteria shall be as stated on the applicable drawings. Also, the bore surfaces of the tube shall be examined by means of a borescope. There shall be no evidence of cracks or fractures.

4.6.4.5 Packaging inspection. Packaging inspection for the level designated in the contract shall be performed in accordance with the applicable packaging data sheets and MIL-P-14232. Packages failing to comply with the packaging requirements shall

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be rejected.

4.6.5 Functional inspections.

4.6.5.1 Functioning tests. The breech mechanism of each assembled cannon shall be operated manually for a minimum of two complete cycles of operation. Cocking action, trigger actuation, firing mechanism action, and breech mechanism operation tests shall be performed to ascertain proper functioning. With the cannon in a horizontal position, extraction shall be tested with an empty service cartridge case. Any evidence of binding, scraping, looseness or other malfunction of any part or failure to completely eject an empty service cartridge case shall be cause for rejection.

4.6.6 Tests.

4.6.6.1 Proof acceptance. Cannon shall be proof accepted through proof firing, proof pressure simulation tests, or both. Cannon and repair tubes to be proof fired shall be fired using the test method of 4.7.1. Failure to comply with the requirements of 3.5.1, 3.5.2, and 3.5.3 shall be cause for rejection. Cannon breech mechanisms to be simulation proof tested shall be proof tested using the test method of 4.7.2. Failure to comply with the requirements of 3.5.1 and 3.5.2 shall be cause for rejection. Proof firing performed on a sampling basis shall be conducted as follows:

a. Using plan CSP-1 of MIL-STD-1235 and an AQL of 1.0, the Product Assurance Directorate at Watervliet Arsenal shall designate the appropriate initial quantity (i) and sample frequency (f), in the contract (see 6.2.1).

b. Tne first "i" quantity of cannon or tubes produced in a particular buy shall be proof fired. When the "i" quantity has been satisfied, sampling shall be put into effect using the "f" sampling frequency. All cannon not proof fired shall have the breech mechanisms simulation proof tested in the Product Assurance weapon test facility at Watervliet Arsenal.

c. Successive production buys shall not require "i" quantities. However, if the time lag between two successive buys exceeds one year, or if a new cannon or tube contractor is uti lized, a new "i" quantity shall be proof fired.

d. Proof fired cannon and replacement tubes, and simulation proof tested breech mechanisms shall be furnished with applicable data on DA Form 2408-4 (Weapon Record Data) as specified by Product Assurance Directorate at Watervliet Arsenal.

e. When specified in the contract (see 6.2.1), the weapon

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simulation test facility shall be qualified as follows: a sample of breech mechanisms of cannon to be sent to the proving ground for proof firing shall be subjected initially to simulation proof testing at the weapon simulation test facility.

4.7 Test methods.

4.7.1 Proof firing. Proof firing shall be conducted at a Government test site. The procedure shall be as follows:

a. Each cannon or repair tube shall be proof fired within the proof pressure range specified in 3.5.1. If the lower limit is not attained, additional rounds shall be fired until the minimum value is attained. The number of additional rounds shall not exceed five.

b. A facility mount may be used if necessary.

c. Chamber pressure shall be measured and recorded.

d. After proof firing:

(1) The bore of each tube shall be examined for bore enlargement using an air gage or other approved gages. Enlargements exceeding the limits specified in TABLE I shall be cause for rejection (see 3.5.3).

(2) Each tube shall be borescoped and magnetic particle inspected (see 4.6.4.4).

(3) Each breech mechanism shall be examined for looseness or interference of fit and other defects of workmanship and function (see 4.6.5.1).

(4) Each breech mechanism shall be disassembled and examined for soundness of material. All components shall be examined to assure freedom from cracks and fractures. Each breech ring and breechblock shall be magnetic particle inspected (see 4.6.4.4).

e. Cannon found to be defective at the proving ground shall be reported to the Product Assurance Directorate, Watervliet Arsenal, Watervliet, NY 12189-5000 and Benet Weapons Lab, Watervliet Arsenal, Watervliet, NY 12189-5000 within one working day. The test agency shall forward an Equipment Performance Report (EPR), incident to the deficiency, within three working days.

4.7.2 Proof pressure simulation. All cannon not proof fired at a proving ground shall have the breech mechanism proof tested in accordance with the following procedure:

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a. Each breech mechanism shall be tested by means of suitable hydraulic pressure testing equipment at a pressure within the proof pressure range specified in 3.5.1.

b. Cycle time to achieve test pressure and release shall not exceed three minutes. Test pressure shall be immediately released upon its attainment. Dwell time at test pressure shall not exceed 0.4 of one second.

(1) When difficulty is encountered in attaining test pressure, the number of attempts in which 10 percent or less of the test pressure is attained shall not be counted. The number of attempts in which over 10 percent of the test pressure is attained, shall not exceed five.

(2) If the cause of difficulty is not identified and corrected within five pressure cycles, the breech mechanism shall be subjected to proof firing as part of a cannon (see 4.7.1). A notification of this condition shall be submitted with the breech mechanism to the proving ground.

c. The peak pressure shall be recorded for each test and attached to inspection records identifiable with the specific breech mechanism undergoing test.

d. After the pressure test, each breech mechanism shall be examined for looseness or interference of fit and other defects of workmanship and function (see 4.6.5.1).

e. Each breech mechanism shall be disassembled and examined for soundness of material. All components shall be visually examined to assure freedom from cracks and fractures. Each breech ring and breechblock shall be magnetic particle inspected (see 4.6.4.4).

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Cannon - Levels A and B. Preservation, packaging and packing of the cannon shall be in accordance with Packaging Data Sheet P11577648 for the level of protection specified in the contract (see 6.2).

5.2 Repair parts.

5.2.1 Levels A and B. Repair parts preservation, packaging and packing shall be in accordance with the applicable packaging data sheet for the level of protection specified in the contract (see 6.2).

5.2.2 Level X-Industrial packaging. Repair parts preservation, packaging, packing and marking shall be in accordance with ASTM D

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3951 when Level X protection is specified in the contract (see 6.2).

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Level A and B. Marking of unit packages and exterior shipping containers shall be in accordance with Packaging Data Sheet P11577648.

5.3.2 Level X - Industrial. Marking shall be in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.3.3 Bar code marking. When specified (see 6.2.1n) bar code marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and MIL-STD-1189.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The cannon specified herein is intended to be used in the Howitzer, Light, Towed, 105MM M102 System.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

6.2.1 Acquisition requirements.

a. Title, number and date of this specification.

b. Requirements for and the number of cannon, components thereof, or both to be submitted for first article by the contractor (see 3.1).

c. The examinations and tests to be performed by the contractor and the examinations and tests to be performed by the Government.

d. All inspection and test data that is required.

e. At whose expense a retest may be performed.

f. Serial numbers for the cannon and tube assemblies.

g. List of inspection equipment, responsibility for acquisition, maintenance, and disposition thereof, if other than as specified (see 4.6.3).

h. Availability of inspection equipment from the Government.

i. Extent of supplier's responsibility for Government-furnished and for supplier-required final inspection equipment.

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j. Applicable acceptance test procedures, initial consecutive quantity (i), and sampling frequency (f) (see 4.6.6.1).

k. Under what conditions simulated firing may be performed, the test equipment available, and the procedures to be followed.

l. When applicable, the sampling plan for the actual firing of tubes.

m. The levels of preservation, packaging, and packing required for cannon (see 5.1) and repair parts (see 5.2).

n. When applicable, bar code marking requirements (see 5.3).

6.2.2 Contract data requirements. Monthly reports of the results of final examination and performance testing shall be as specified for delivery on DD Form 1423 in the contract.
6.2.2.1 When this specification is used in an acquisition which incorporates a DD Form 1423, Contract Data Requirements List (CDRL), the data requirements identified below shall be developed as specified by an approved Data Item Description (DD Form 1664) and delivered in accordance with the approved CDRL incorporated into the contract. When the provisions of DOD FAR Supplement 52.227-7031 are invoked and the DD Form 1423 is not used, the data specified below shall be delivered by the contractor in accordance with the contract or purchase order requirements. Deliverable data required by this specification is cited in the following paragraphs.

Paragraph No.	Data Requirement Title	Applicable DID No.
3.1	First Article Inspection Report	DI-T-4902

(Data item descriptions related to this specification, and identified in Section 6 will be approved and listed as such in DoD 5000.19L., Volume II, AMSDL. Copies of data item descriptions required by the contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the Naval Publications and Forms Center or as directed by the Contracting Officer).

6.3 When warranted, the contract should specify the application of MIL-Q-9858 or MIL-I-45208, as appropriate.

6.4 Unless otherwise specified, the contract should specify the application of MIL-I-45607 and MIL-STD-45662.

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6.5 Definition. Frequency of testing is defined as the proportion of the lot to be tested after initial 100 percent testing.

6.6 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

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Preparing activity:

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Project No. 1015-A313

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-45579B	CANNON, 105MM, HOWITZER: M137A1

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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